

CONTACT

303-330-9660
wilkins507@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/collin-wilkins-1020215a
collinwilkins.com

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Re-architected event-driven compliance engine: ~90% less processing volume/time, +35% throughput.
- Built Kafka/Pub/Sub consumers ingesting 600k+ vehicle events/day.
- Shipped vehicle-to-cloud event system across 450k+ vehicles, saving ~\$5M/yr.
- Onboarded 23+ enterprise clients under Zero Trust; cut defects 42% via AI adoption.

TECHNICAL STACK

Languages Java, Kotlin, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript

Backend Spring Boot, Node.js, REST, GraphQL, event-driven architecture, microservices

Data/Messaging PostgreSQL, AWS RDS, Kafka, GCP Pub/Sub, Redis, MongoDB, SQL tuning

Cloud/Infra AWS (Lambda, SQS, SNS), GCP, Azure, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CloudFormation, CI/CD

Platform/Delivery GitHub Actions, CodeBuild/CodePipeline, quality gates, feature flags, env promotion & rollback, secrets mgmt, artifact repos, Jira

Security Zero Trust, OAuth2/OIDC, SSO/ADFS, RBAC, audit & data boundaries, IAM, TLS, secure SDLC

AI Claude Code, Codex, Copilot, agent frameworks, MCP, prompt contracts, RAG/pgvector

Reliability Splunk, Grafana, Prometheus, CloudTrail, SLOs, runbooks, incident response

EDUCATION

MBA — Lipscomb University
Nashville, TN · 2016

BS, Business Administration
Finance & Accounting
CU Boulder · 2013

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Cloud Practitioner (2025)
- Azure Fundamentals AZ-900 (2024)
- Google Kubernetes Engine (2024)
- Google Cybersecurity Foundations (2024)

COLLIN WILKINS

Lead Engineer · Distributed Systems · Event-Driven Backend · AI-Native Delivery

Lead engineer with 5+ years building highly distributed, event-driven systems in Java, Kotlin, and Python across AWS, GCP, and Azure. Deep in messaging pipelines (Kafka, Pub/Sub, SQS), PostgreSQL data modeling and tuning, and fault-tolerant microservice design for regulated financial services and connected-vehicle platforms at fleet scale. AI-native developer using Claude Code, Codex, and Copilot — with read-only review agents and verification loops — to accelerate delivery without weakening security or maintainability.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Morningstar, Inc. · Detroit, MI

2024 – Present

Lead Engineer

- Re-architected** a compliance-processing engine in Java around AWS SQS, Lambda, and event-driven processing — cutting processing volume and time ~90% and improving throughput/latency 35%, delivering near-real-time data availability and a scalable architecture other services now reuse.
- Built** Fiduciary Manager end-to-end — a self-service platform letting decision-makers apply fiduciary decisions directly to plans and funds, replacing a manual operations handoff with enforced validation, RBAC, and a full audit trail. Vue.js UI over a Java, SQS/Lambda/PostgreSQL backend.
- Led** architecture and delivery of secure AWS services for regulated financial clients — onboarded 23+ enterprise recordkeepers via Zero Trust, OAuth/SSO coordination, deployment planning, and production-readiness reviews.
- Own** PostgreSQL/AWS RDS workflows for customer-facing services — index and query tuning, queue-aware data flows, and runbook/alert coverage to keep regulated workloads reliable in production.
- Cut** defects 42% by leading AI engineering adoption and hardening CI/CD with automated quality gates (SonarQube, Wiz, Semgrep) — migrating the build/deploy stack to AWS CodeBuild + CodePipeline with feature flags, environment promotion, and rollback, cutting cycle time ~20%. Drove adoption through a shared skills repository, AGENT.md context files, and a read-only code-review agent.

Ford Motor Company · Dearborn, MI

2021 – 2024

Full-Stack Software Engineer — Connected Vehicle

- Built** Kafka and GCP Pub/Sub consumers ingesting 600k+ vehicle events/day, with controls for customer-location privacy, message reliability, and downstream service contracts.
- Led** re-architecture of a remote dealership inventory audit platform into a lightweight vehicle-to-cloud event system covering 450k+ vehicles and saving ~\$5M annually.
- Designed** telemetry-driven theft anticipation and recovery for the 2024 Ford F-150, integrating vehicle event streams, cloud services, and service-to-service messaging for real-time response.
- Built** Azure/GCP IoT microservices for connected-vehicle telemetry and OTA-adjacent workflows across millions of vehicles under privacy, reliability, and fleet-scale messaging constraints.

Ford Motor Company · Dearborn, MI

2013 – 2021

Pricing & Strategy Manager · Business Development · Leadership Development Program

- Built** digital pricing tools delivering \$2.2M in annual savings; served as technical sales advisor across 13 dealer accounts (\$75M AUM), capturing \$10M through tailored engagements. Completed a 3-year rotational Leadership Development Program while earning an MBA.

AI, AUTOMATION & SELECTED PROJECTS

AI-Native Engineering System · [collinwilkins.com](#)

- Created** repeatable workflows for prompt contracts, read-only code-review agents, codebase mapping, and verification loops that require tests, diffs, and human approval before changes ship.

Firmware Risk Triage Portal · [Next.js](#) · [Supabase](#) · [PostgreSQL](#) · 2026

- Built** a product-security portal with tenant-shaped data models for SBOMs and vulnerabilities — Postgres functions/views/triggers, RLS, migrations, and CI security scanning.

Automation & Document Workflows · [Python](#) · [Modal](#) · [GitHub Actions](#)

- Built** automated client-onboarding pipelines with webhooks, API integrations, templating, and GitHub Actions-backed document generation.